PRISONS WEEK 2026 11–17 OCTOBER, WITH THE THEME "ALL ARE INVITED," INSPIRED BY MATTHEW 22:1–14.
The week begins with Prisoners' Sunday on 11 October and focuses on prayer and action for victims of crime, offenders, families, and all working in the criminal justice system. Prisons week raises awareness and generates prayer. It motivates volunteers to step forward and give their time and gifts, in prisons and in their own communities. It provides an annual focus and reason for Christians to work together, building capacity and motivation to make a difference for people who are out of sight and often out of mind.

THE PRISONS WEEK PRAYER

Lord, you offer freedom to all people. We pray for those in prison.
Break the bonds of fear and isolation that exist.
Support with your love prisoners and their families and friends, prison staff and all who care.
Heal those who have been wounded by the activities of others, especially the victims of crime.
Help us to forgive one another.
To act justly, love mercy and walk humbly together with Christ
in His strength and in His Spirit, now and every day. Amen.

PATHWAYS TO THE FUTURE are pleased to invite you to a Zoom training evening introducing the **Sycamore Advent programme**. This session will provide an overview of the programme, explain how it can be used in parish communities during Advent, and offer practical guidance and resources to help you lead sessions. There will also be an opportunity to ask questions and share ideas with other parish leaders.
Date: Tuesday 20th October 2026 **Time:** 7pm – 8.30pm **Venue:** Zoom
The training is intended for lay parish leaders and anyone involved in evangelisation, catechesis, small groups or parish formation. No previous experience with Sycamore is required. Please confirm your attendance by completing the booking link by **15th October.** https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/f7S5ycvmn2

RECHARGE YOUNG ADULT GROUP ST COLUMCILLE'S CHURCH, BELFAST
All young adults aged 18-35 are welcome to the following event in St Colmcille's, Belfast:
20th October @ 7.30pm - Group Study

LISBURN CITY LIBRARY will host a **Positive Ageing Fair** on **Tuesday 13 October from 10:00am – 1:00pm** as part of Positive Ageing Month. This free, drop-in event will showcase the wide range of opportunities available in the Lisburn area for older people who want to explore new interests, rediscover old passions or simply meet others in a welcoming space. Visitors can chat with representatives from local organisations covering everything from arts and crafts, history and photography to sport, volunteering, health and lifelong learning.
Groups taking part on the day include the NI Family History Society, Lagan Valley Rural Transport, Earlybirds Choir, South Eastern Trust and Lisburn and Castlereagh City Council's Age Friendly and Be Active Stay Active teams and many more. Everyone is welcome to drop in any time between 10:00am and 1:00pm.

